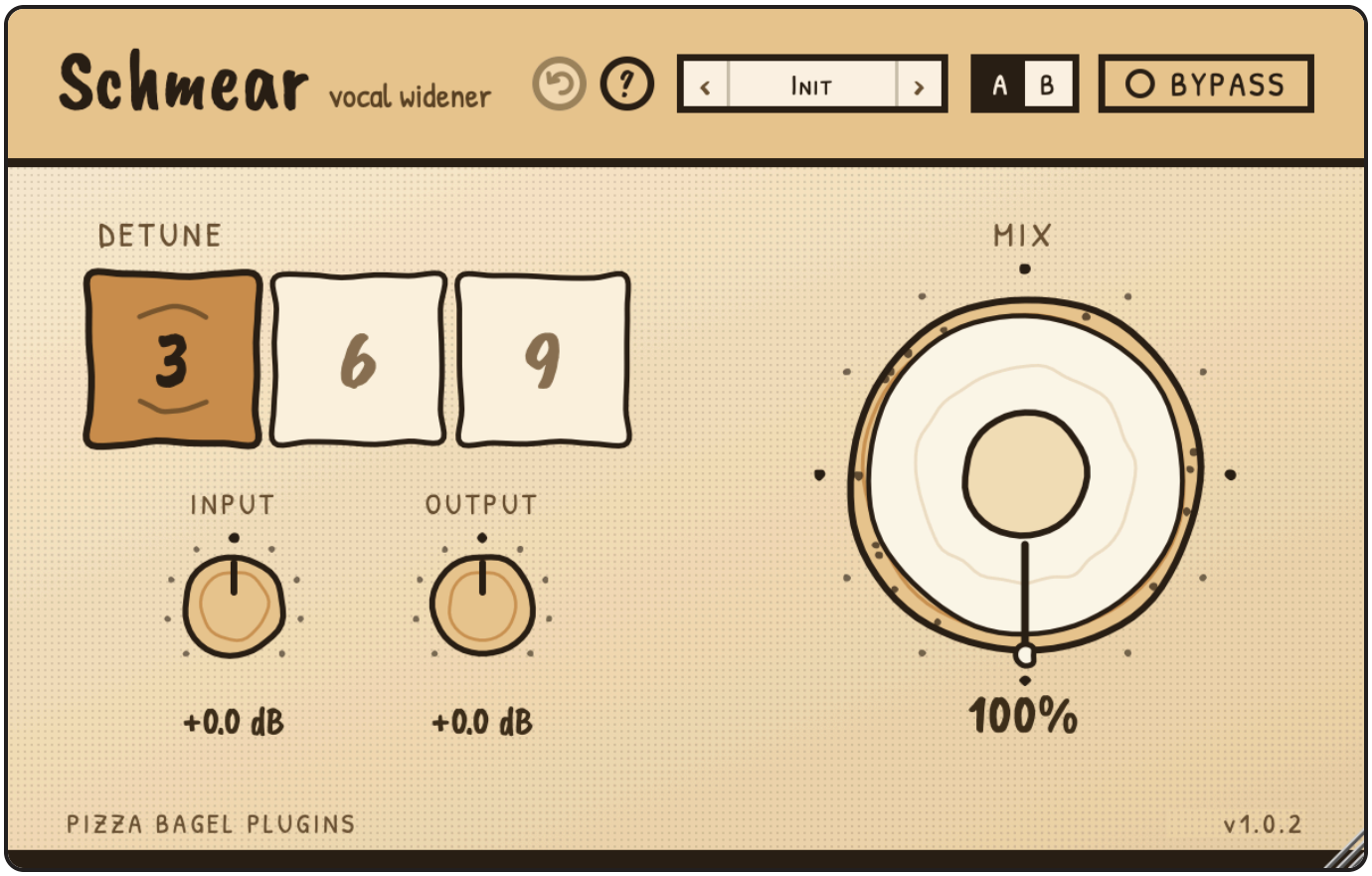
Schmear

vocal widener

User manual

VERSION 1.0.3

Two slightly detuned copies of your track, one either side, for instant width and sheen.



The panel as it opens: 3 cents, 100% mix. Three settings, one knob, two trims.

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Schmear is a vocal widener built on the detune trick every mix engineer knows from the great 1980s studio rack effects: one copy of the signal a few cents sharp on the left, one a few cents flat on the right, with a touch of delay and tone shaping. On vocals it is a sheen, on guitars it is a doubler, on synths it is width that stays in tune. It is a delay-line shifter running at your session rate, so there is nothing to alias.

In a hurry? Install and activate, then go straight to Quick start. It is four steps.

Installing on Mac

1. Double-click the Pizza Bagel installer package. One installer covers every Pizza Bagel plugin. It asks for your Mac password, because plug-ins live in system folders.
2. On the **Customize** screen, tick the plugins you want, then the formats: **VST3**, **Audio Unit** and **AAX**. If you're not sure, leave all three formats ticked; each one is only used by the DAWs that support it.
3. **Fully quit your DAW (Cmd+Q) and start it again.** Rescanning inside a running DAW is not enough; it can keep an old copy in memory.

The installer puts the plug-in in the standard places for every user on the Mac:

FORMAT	WHERE	WORKS IN
Audio Unit	`/Library/Audio/Plug-Ins/Components`	Logic Pro, GarageBand, Live, and any AU host
VST3	`/Library/Audio/Plug-Ins/VST3`	Live, Cubase, Studio One, Reaper, and any VST3 host
AAX	`/Library/Application Support/Avid/Audio/Plug-Ins`	Pro Tools 11 and later, no iLok needed

The installer and every plug-in are signed with an Apple Developer ID and notarized, so macOS opens them without warnings. The AAX is signed for Pro Tools and needs no iLok. The plug-in is a universal binary: it runs natively on Apple Silicon and Intel Macs, and it appears in Pro Tools when Pro Tools runs under Rosetta. Requires macOS 13.3 or later.

Live: after installing, open Settings, Plug-Ins and make sure the Audio Units and VST3 system folders are switched on, then Rescan.

Installing on Windows

1. Double-click the Pizza Bagel installer. If Windows shows "Windows protected your PC", click **More info**, then **Run anyway**. The installer is safe; it just is not registered with Microsoft yet.
2. Tick the plugins you want, then the formats: **VST3** and, for Pro Tools, **AAX**.

3. **Fully quit your DAW and start it again.**

Requires Windows 10 or later, 64-bit.

In DAWs that sort VST3 plug-ins by category, Schmear is listed under Modulation.

FORMAT	WHERE	WORKS IN
VST3	`C:\Program Files\Common Files\VST3`	Live, Cubase, Studio One, Reaper, FL Studio, Bitwig, and any VST3 host
AAX	`C:\Program Files\Common Files\Avid\Audio\Plug-Ins`	Pro Tools 11 and later, no iLok needed

The user guide is in the Start menu under Pizza Bagel Plugins. To remove the plug-in, use Settings, Apps. Keyboard shortcuts use Ctrl where the Mac uses Cmd: Ctrl-Z for undo, Shift or Ctrl while dragging for fine steps, Alt-click to reset a knob.

Where your files live

	MAC	WINDOWS
Your presets	`~/Library/Audio/Presets/Pizza Bagel Plugins/Schmear`	`Documents\Pizza Bagel Plugins\Schmear\Presets`
Factory preset packs	`/Library/Audio/Presets/Pizza Bagel Plugins/Schmear/Factory`	`C:\ProgramData\Pizza Bagel Plugins\Schmear\Factory`
Shared panel settings	`~/Library/Application Support/Pizza Bagel Plugins`	`%APPDATA%\Pizza Bagel Plugins`

"Show in Finder" in the preset menu opens File Explorer on Windows.

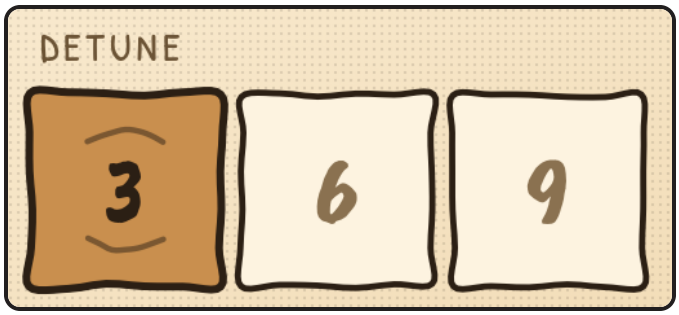
Quick start

1. Insert Schmear on a vocal, guitar or synth.
2. Pick the spread: **3** for a hair of shine, **6** for a clear double, **9** for the full smear.
3. Drag the bagel (**MIX**) to set how much of it you hear. Double-click or Option-click for 100%.

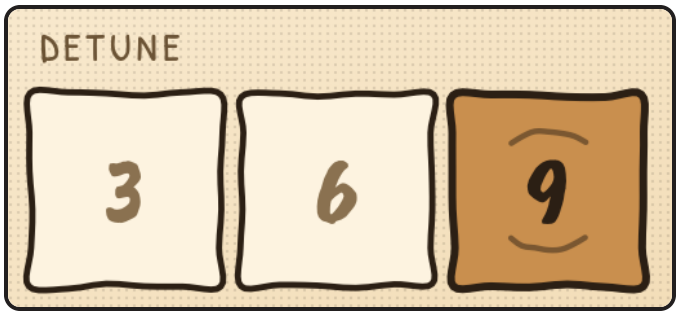
4. Two extra voices add level, so pull **OUTPUT** back a little if you need to match the bypassed sound.

Insert or send: Schmear sounds great both inserted directly on a source and on a send. My preference is a send, with **MIX** at 100%, then the send level sets how much you hear. Justin

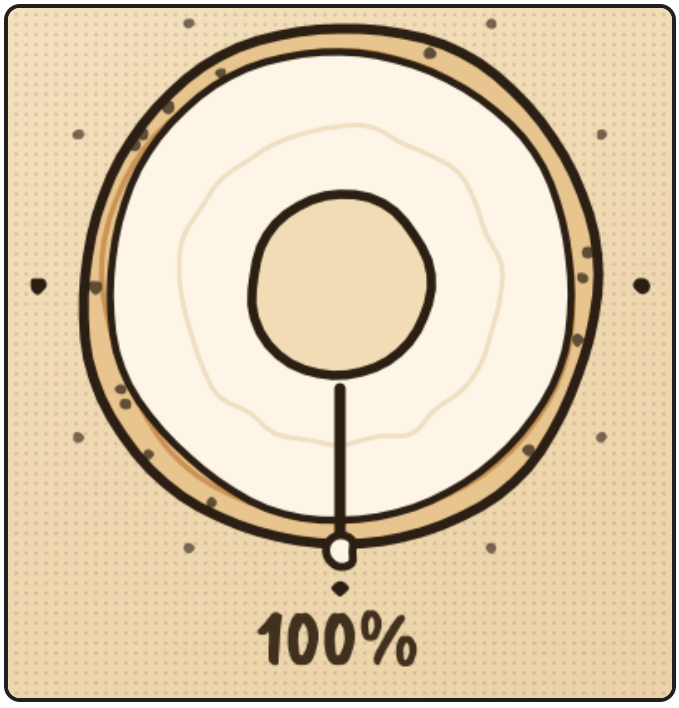
Controls



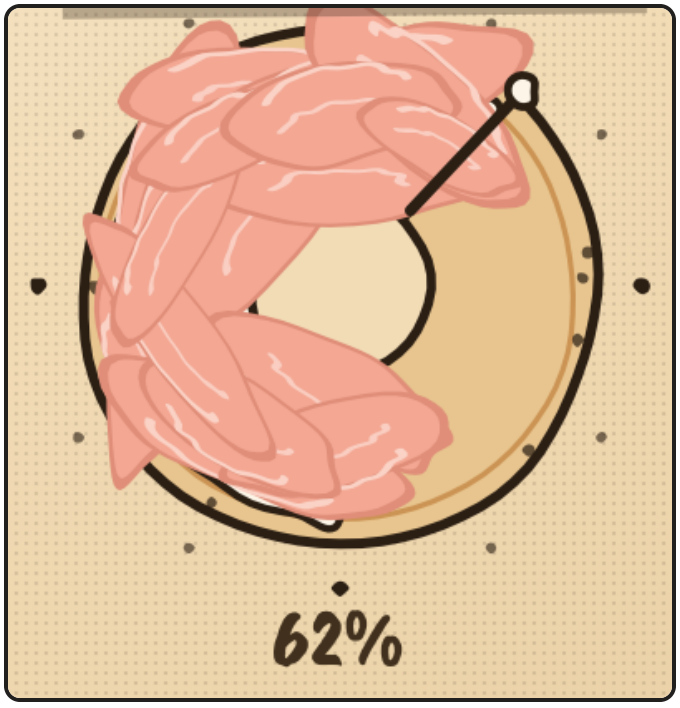
DETUNE on 3: the plain bagel



DETUNE on 9: the lox



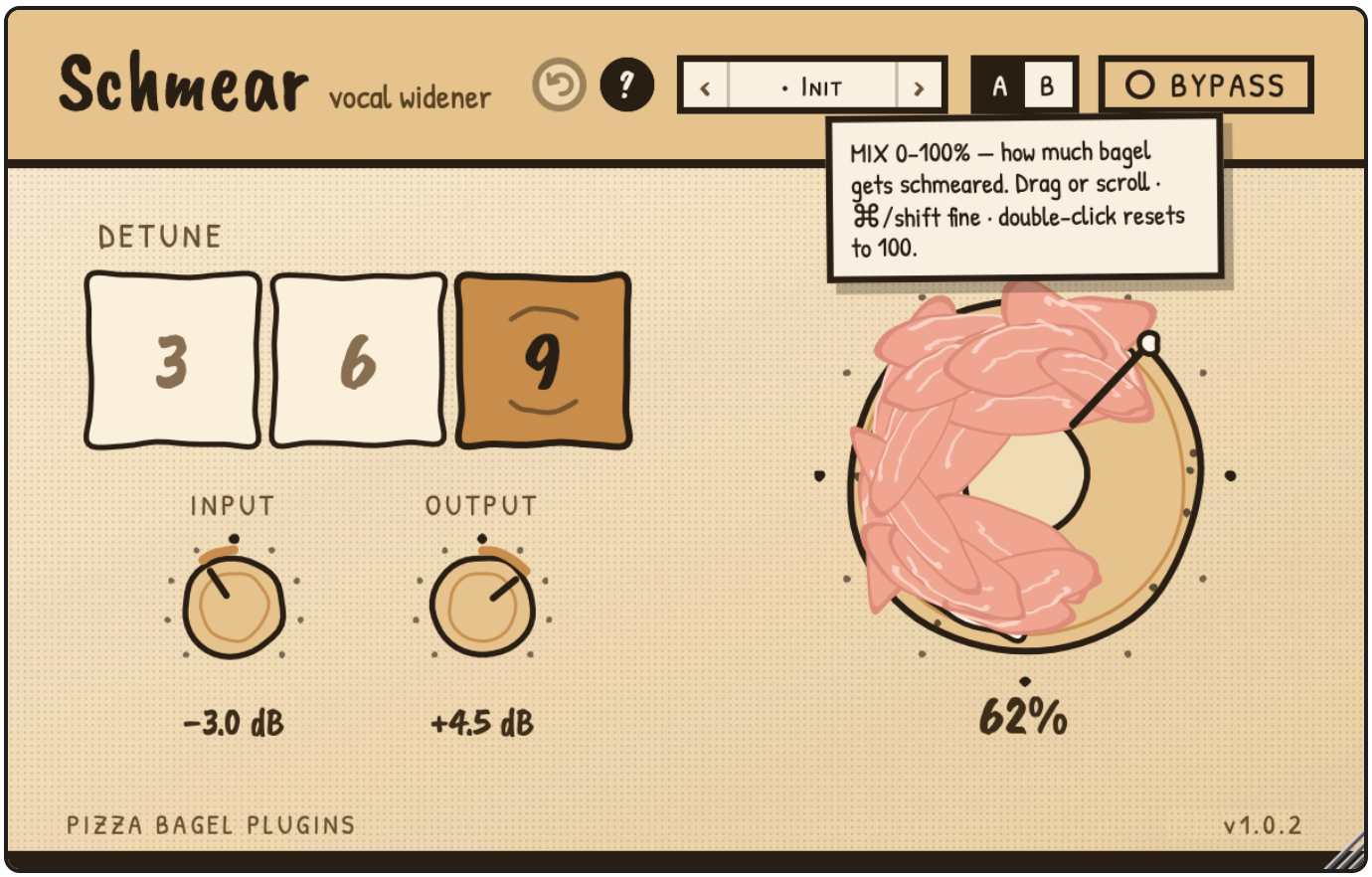
MIX at 100%, 3 cents



MIX at 62%, 9 cents

CONTROL	WHAT IT DOES
3 / 6 / 9	The detune spread in cents. The bagel's topping follows: plain, scallion, lox.
MIX (THE BAGEL)	Dry/wet. Drag or scroll to spread the schmear; Shift or Cmd for fine; double-click or Option-click is 100%.
INPUT / OUTPUT	±12 dB trims. Double-click or Option-click resets to 0 dB.
BYPASS	The whole box out of circuit: the panel grays out and the output matches the input exactly, trims and all.

Working with the panel



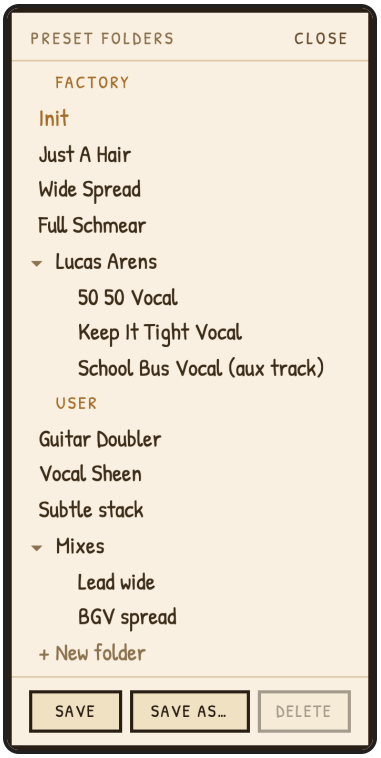
Tooltips on: hovering MIX. Here at 9 cents, 62% mix, INPUT at −3 dB and OUTPUT at +4.5 dB.

Knobs follow your hand: drag slowly for fine moves and quickly for big ones; a full sweep is about 250 pixels at a steady pace. Hold Shift or Cmd while dragging for fine steps, five times finer. The scroll wheel nudges in small steps, finer still with Shift or Cmd. Double-click a knob, or Option-click it, to reset it; a Cmd-click without moving does the same.

- **Tooltips are off to begin with.** Click the **?** to turn them on, then hover any control for a short note; click it again to turn them off. The **?** always shows its own note, so you can tell which way it is set. A choice you have already made is kept.
- **Undo** (the arrow, or Cmd-Z): forty steps, and it survives closing the window.
- **A / B** holds two complete states and briefly rings whatever differs when you switch.
- **Presets**: arrows step, click the name for the browser. More under Presets below.
- **Resize** from any corner; the size is remembered.

Presets

Click the preset name for the browser; the arrows either side step through it in the order it shows. A dot in front of the name means you have moved off the saved settings.



The browser: FACTORY above USER

THE BROWSER

FACTORY holds Init, Just A Hair, Wide Spread and Full Schmear, plus any preset packs installed for the whole Mac, one folder per pack. 1.0.2 comes with a Lucas Arens pack: 50 50 Vocal, Keep It Tight Vocal and School Bus Vocal (aux track). It installs with the plug-in. Factory presets can be loaded and copied, never changed.

USER is yours. Guitar Doubler and Vocal Sheen are put there on first run. The files live in `~/Library/Audio/Presets/Pizza Bagel Plugins/Schmear` (on Windows, `Documents\Pizza Bagel Plugins\Schmear\Presets`), and a folder in the browser is a real folder there.

A long list scrolls with the mouse wheel.

SAVE, SAVE AS, DELETE

SAVE always asks for a name and a folder. Keep the name to update the preset you are on, or type a new one to keep both versions. If the name already belongs to another of your presets in that folder, Schmear asks before replacing it. **SAVE AS** starts from a fresh name. **DELETE** moves the loaded user preset to the Trash; it is grayed out while a factory preset is loaded.

THE ROW MENU

Hover a preset and click the three dots, or right-click it (ctrl-click works too). Your presets offer **Save, Save as, Rename, Duplicate, Move to** (any folder, Top level, or a new folder), **Delete** (to the Trash) and **Show in Finder**. Factory presets offer **Save as** and **Save a copy to User**. Right-clicking the name in the top bar opens the same menu for the loaded preset.



A user preset's row menu

FOLDERS

"+ New folder" at the bottom of USER makes one. Click a folder to fold or unfold it; Schmear remembers which are folded. A folder's own menu has **Rename folder**, **Delete folder** (to the Trash, and it asks first when there are presets inside) and **Show in Finder**.

Presets carry spread, mix, input and output, never bypass. Your session remembers which preset was loaded, folder included.

Good to know

- Opens on 3 cents at 100% mix.
- Mono inputs on a stereo track are handled: the mono signal is mirrored to both sides, and the two voices spread from there.
- Moving the mix knob and engaging bypass are click-free.
- Window size and the tooltip switch are shared by every Schmear instance in every DAW: change one and the others follow, and new instances open the same way.

AUTOMATION

Every control is automatable in every DAW. In Pro Tools, hold control+option+command and click a control to enable automation for that parameter, as with most plug-ins; the 3/6/9 presses and BYPASS are recorded too.

MIDI LEARN

Right-click a knob, a detune cell or BYPASS, choose LEARN MIDI CC, then move a control on your MIDI controller; right-click again to clear it. Any CC on any channel works, and the hover note on a mapped control shows its CC. Mappings are saved with the session, not with presets. To get

MIDI into the plug-in: in Pro Tools, set a MIDI track's output to the Schmear insert; in other DAWs, route a MIDI track or your controller to the plug-in's MIDI input.

License activation

The first time you open the plug-in, an activation screen covers the panel and the plug-in is silent until it's activated. Schmear is free, but it still needs a license: check it out for **$0** from its page in the store so the license lands on your account. One license covers **three computers**. No iLok is needed.

1. Click **Activate online**. Your browser opens the Pizza Bagel Plugins store; sign in with the account you checked Schmear out with.
2. Back in your DAW, the screen confirms the activation within a few seconds and the panel comes alive.
3. Every instance of the plug-in on this computer, in every DAW, shares the one activation.

No internet on the studio machine? Click **Activate offline**: save the request file it gives you, upload it to the store from any computer that is online, and load the response file back into the plug-in. Offline activations stay on that machine until you release them from your account.

Your license. Click the version number at the bottom right of the panel to see the license details and how many of your three computers are in use, and to **deactivate** this computer, which frees the seat for another one.

If the activation screen says this computer can't be identified, write to hello@pizzabagelplugins.com and we will sort it out. It affects a small number of Windows PCs.

Feedback

If something sounds wrong or behaves unexpectedly, send a note with your DAW, its version, your sample rate and buffer size, and what you were doing when it happened.

GET IN TOUCH

Bugs, license trouble, feature ideas: use the contact form at pizzabagelplugins.com, or email hello@pizzabagelplugins.com. A real person reads every one. We are a small company, so please give us up to 3 to 5 business days to reply.

Pizza Bagel Plugins. All product names on the panels are the plug-in's own labels for its voicings and modes.